GHAgentCI validation: coding guide

Precision and recall labelling, MSR 2027

Version 2, 29 October 2026

In one paragraph

awe scans GitHub Actions workflow files and reports the places where it believes a *coding agent* (Claude, Codex, Copilot, ...) is started by CI. You will check a sample of those reports, and a sample of workflows it did *not* flag, by opening each workflow on GitHub and answering two questions. Your answers measure how often awe is right (precision) and what it misses (recall). Two coders answer independently; agreement between you is part of the result.

1. What you received

File	What it is
`GHAgentCI-labeling-coder-X.xlsx`	Your workbook. Tabs: *Start here*, *Codebook* (quick reference), *Precision* (576 units), *Recall* (200 units). Only yellow cells are yours to fill.
`GHAgentCI-coding-guide.pdf`	This guide.
`GHAgentCI-calibration.xlsx`	(shared folder) 30 practice units, coded *together* in the calibration session. Not counted.

2. Steps and timing

1. **Calibration session (together, about 1 hour).** Code the 30 units of `GHAgentCI-calibration.xlsx` jointly, discuss every disagreement, and settle the open rule in Section 6. This guide is updated afterwards if a rule changes.
2. **Precision tab, alone (about 10 hours).** 576 units.
3. **Recall tab, alone (about 3 hours).** 200 units.
4. **Return your workbook by 3 November 2026**, unchanged in structure, to Daniel Ogenrwot. Disagreements are then resolved together on 4 November.

At about one minute per unit, that is roughly 13 hours of coding: plan for about two and a half hours a day until 3 November. Save often.

3. Rules

- **Work independently.** Do not discuss units with the other coder, and do not look at their workbook, until both are returned. Ask questions about the *guide* to Daniel instead.
- **Code it yourself.** Do not use AI assistants or scripts to answer; the point is a human judgement.
- **Judge the workflow, not the detector.** The workbook deliberately does not show what awe decided. Do not look it up.
- **Do not add, delete, rename or reorder columns.** Sorting or filtering rows is fine; every answer is matched by `unit_id`.

- **When in doubt, write a short note** in the `notes` column. Notes are read during adjudication and cost you nothing.

4. How to look at a unit

Click the link in the `open workflow` column. It opens the workflow file on GitHub *at the commit being judged*, not today's version.

- `scope = step`: judge the step identified by `job_id` and `step_index`. Steps are counted from `0` within their job: index `0` is the first entry under that job's `steps:`. `step_name`, when present, is the step's `name:`. An index of `-1` means the job itself calls another workflow (`jobs.<job>.uses:`); judge that call.
- `scope = file`: judge the workflow as a whole. This is used when the evidence concerns the entire file: a reserved file name, a credential set for the whole workflow, or a GitHub Agentic Workflows (gh-aw) file.
- **Recall tab:** units have no step. Judge the whole file: does it invoke a coding agent *anywhere*?
- If a link no longer resolves (repository deleted or made private), answer `maybe` for Q1 and write `link dead` in `notes`.

5. Q1 — Does this step (or file) invoke a coding agent when the workflow runs?

A *coding agent* is an LLM-based tool that acts on the repository or its activity: it reads code, diffs, issues or comments, and produces reviews, comments, labels, commits or pull requests.

Answer	Use when
`yes`	The step (or file) runs such an agent when the workflow executes.
`maybe`	An LLM is called but it is unclear that it acts as an agent, or the agent step cannot actually run (disabled, dry-run only).
`no`	No agent runs. The match is incidental.

Decision rules for common cases

Case	Q1
Step uses a vendor's agent action, e.g. `anthropics/claude-code-action`, `openai/codex-action`, `google-github-actions/run-gemini-cli`	`yes`
Shell step runs an agent CLI, e.g. `claude -p "..."`, `codex exec`, `gemini -p`, `aider --message`	`yes`
A third-party action that wraps an agent (e.g. an "AI PR reviewer" calling Claude or GPT on the diff and posting a review)	`yes`
File `.github/workflows/copilot-setup-steps.yml` (prepares the Copilot coding agent's environment)	`yes`
gh-aw file: a compiled `*.lock.yml` with a "generated by gh-aw" header, or its Markdown source with gh-aw frontmatter	`yes`
Agent step guarded by `if: false`, or a mode that only prints what it would do	`maybe`
Single LLM call that only summarises or formats text (release notes, changelog), not acting on code	`maybe`
Step only *installs* an agent (`npm i -g @openai/codex`) and nothing in that step runs it	`no`
An API key such as `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` feeds a test suite or an application, not an agent	`no`
The agent's name appears only in an `echo`, a comment, documentation, or a file path	`no`
An unrelated tool that shares an agent's name	`no`
File is not a working workflow (e.g. ordinary Markdown in `.github/workflows/`)	`no`
Invalid YAML: judge what the author evidently intended the step to do	as above

6. Settled at calibration

Open until the calibration session: a step that only calls a generic LLM inference action, such as `actions/ai-inference`, to summarise or classify an issue. Is that `yes` or `maybe`?

Decision: _____

7. Q2 — Which agent is it?

Answer Q2 only when Q1 is `yes` or `maybe`; leave it empty for `no`. Pick one value from the dropdown. Spelling matters: answers are compared literally.

Value	Use when
`claude` `codex` `copilot` `gemini`	The vendor's agent, directly or through a wrapper action that clearly uses it.
`cursor` `aider` `devin` `pr_agent`	`pr_agent` is Qodo's PR-Agent (`Codium-ai/pr-agent`).
`coderabbit` `goose` `opencode` `openhands`	
`generic_ai`	A third-party AI action not tied to one of the vendors above.
`unknown`	A gh-aw file that does not say which engine it uses.
`other`	A coding agent not in this list.
`unclear`	Cannot be determined from the workflow.

For gh-aw files, the engine is the `engine:` key of the Markdown source, or the `agent_id` in the lock file's `gh-aw-metadata` header; if neither is present, answer `unknown`.

8. Worked examples

scope	job / step	What you see	Q1	Q2
step	`review` / 1	`uses: anthropics/claude-code-action@v1` with a review prompt	`yes`	`claude`
step	`test` / 3	`run: pytest`, with `OPENAI_API_KEY` in `env:`	`no`	
file	–	`copilot-setup-steps.yml` installing project dependencies	`yes`	`copilot`
step	`triage` / 0	`run: echo "ask @claude for help"`	`no`	
file	–	`issue-triage.lock.yml` whose header names engine `codex`	`yes`	`codex`

9. Questions

Ask Daniel Ogenrwot (ogenrwot@unlv.nevada.edu). Questions about a specific unit go in its `notes` instead, so that they do not influence the other coder.